

Decent Coaching Classes
IX CBSE
Academic Conquest - VI
ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME

Subject: English (Kaveri) | Time: 1 Hour

Maximum Marks: 30

SECTION A **(5 × 1 = 5 marks)**

1. (b) the feather of a bird [1]
2. (c) AABB (deep–seep, true–hue) [1]
3. (b) a stranger to whom Grandpa had given the cap [1]
4. (c) shiuli flowers [1]
5. (a) damage caused to an object by normal use [1]

SECTION B **(5 × 2 = 10 marks)**

6. 1 mark for each state (type + distinguishing feature). Any one valid example per state: [2]
Rajasthan: appliqué fan (pieces of fabric in different shapes sewn onto another cloth with ornamental needlework) / zardozi fan (glittering gold threadwork) / temple fan (engraved brass with a long handle) / painted fan (cardboard fan with images, offered to gods).
Gujarat: mirror-work fan (pure cotton embellished with mirror work) / beads fan (covered with colourful beads, silver handle) / Kutch leather fan (hand-stitched, decorated with thread and wool) / embroidered fan (mirror work and cross-stitch).
7. 1 mark each, any two: [2]
palette → the earth / soil; brushstrokes → seeds; canvas → each garden plot; painter → gardener.
8. 1 mark – Grandpa’s memory was failing (he was forgetful in his old age). [2]
1 mark – Evidence/wish: he had taken a double dose of medicines and got lost on a walk, so she wished a ‘memory vitamin’ could improve old people’s memories.
9. **Ravi asked Grandpa whether (if) they should play chess or watch the cricket match on TV.** [2]
1 mark – correct reporting verb with ‘whether/if’ and statement word order (no question mark/inverted order).
1 mark – correct change of ‘shall’ to ‘should’ and the pronoun (‘we’ → ‘they’); ‘Grandpa’ shifted to the reporting clause.
10. 1 mark each, any two (sense + example): [2]
Auditory (hearing) – the tune of the song she used to hum while rocking his cradle.
Olfactory (smell) – the smell of shiuli flowers / the scent of the morning service in the temple.
Visual (sight) – the stillness of her gaze spread over the blue sky.

SECTION C **(3 × 3 = 9 marks)**

11. (a) [1 mark] The arrival (advent) of technology and innovative creations / modern alternatives. [3]
(b) [1 + 1 marks] Any two: celebrating and appreciating pankhas and the culture and artistry they stand for; organising pankha-making workshops and handicraft exhibitions to spread awareness; giving artisans a commercial platform for a sustainable livelihood.

12. (i) [1 mark] Alliteration (repetition of the 'b' sound). [3]
 (ii) [1 mark] The shades of green, red and blue in the blossoms make the garden look like a painting created by Nature, the artist.
 (iii) [1 mark] Appreciative / admiring / joyful (any one suitable tone).
13. (i) [1 mark] At his bedroom window (indoors), looking at the distant blue sky. [3]
 (ii) [1 mark] He feels his mother's calm, loving and watchful presence all around him, as vast as the sky; the sky becomes a symbol of her presence.
 (iii) [1 mark] Serenity / peace / comfort (also accept longing/nostalgia with justification); supported by 'stillness' or 'blue of the distant sky'. ½ mark for emotion + ½ mark for the supporting word or phrase.

SECTION D

(1 × 6 = 6 marks)

14. (a) **Character sketch of Grandpa** [6]

Marking: Content – 4 marks (any three traits with evidence: 1 mark each, plus 1 mark for a clear introduction/overall impression); Expression and organisation – 2 marks.

Possible traits and evidence (any three):

Independent and self-reliant – looked after himself for about seventy-five years, cooked and kept house after his wife's death, resents being treated like a baby.

Sharp-minded – recalls thousands of chess games and the moves of Karpov and Fischer; remembers to give gifts to everyone on his birthday.

Witty and crafty – gets Ravi to admit he has no objection to his going out; later hints that he knew he was being followed (the detective stories gift, the 'Vitamin-M' remark).

Generous and kind – gives his cap to a stranger; gives gifts to every 'child' in the house on his own birthday.

Fond of simple pleasures and his home – enjoys tea, bananas and ice cream; misses his brick house and mango tree.

Sample answer:

Grandpa, a lawyer by profession, is a sharp, independent and playful man. Although his daughter thinks he is forgetful, he can recall thousands of chess games and the moves of Karpov and Fischer. He is fiercely self-reliant; after his wife's death he managed the cooking, shopping and housekeeping himself, and he resents being treated like a baby. He is also witty and crafty. He slips out for a walk, tricks Ravi into admitting that he has no objection, and later gifts him a book of detective stories, which shows he knew he was being followed. His generosity is seen when he gives his cap to a stranger and gives gifts to everyone on his own birthday.

OR

- (b) **Article: Keeping Our Crafts Alive**

Marking: Format (title and byline) – 1 mark; Content – 3 marks (the pankha tradition and its regional variety; the risk to the craft; ways to preserve it); Expression, coherence and accuracy – 2 marks.

Sample answer:

Keeping Our Crafts Alive

By: A member of the Heritage Club

India's handicrafts are living stories, and the pankha, or hand fan, is one of the loveliest. Once used to fan deities and kings, pankhas were made of bamboo, palm leaf, silk or brass, and every region gave them its own look: Rajasthan's appliqué and zardozi fans, Gujarat's mirror-work and bead fans, and Bengal's delicate sola fans. Today, with the advent of technology, this culture risks fading away. We can help by visiting handicraft exhibitions, joining pankha-making workshops and buying directly from artisans, which gives them a sustainable livelihood. When we celebrate such crafts, we preserve our identity. Let us ensure that the winds of change do not blow our heritage away.

— End of Answer Key —